

grow the business with the B2B guys. They give us access to the market and with one interface, they get the inventory as opposed to dealing with many carriers. This is a real-time process, and they look at the inventory the way we do. The way to do it is to grow together and it does not matter how the traveller makes a booking.

Each market is interesting. In the US, it is dominated by travel agencies and people physically meeting them. We have over 10,000 B2B partners there and in India and China, it is dominated by digital platforms. In Australia, two-thirds of travellers make their booking through travel agencies.

Q: What trends are you seeing specifically with reference to Indians travelling to Europe in, say, choice of destinations?

A: The market is continuously changing. In the past, Indians going to Europe would mean going to Switzerland. Maybe a lot of that has to do with films shot there influencing the decision. Beyond that, the preferred destinations would be London and Paris.

The big change is a lot of Indians now are looking at the next set of destinations—it could be Vienna,

Budapest, the Nordics, or Amsterdam—with the desire to discover new things. For instance, Indians going to Portugal is a reality and we must recognise that. There is a diverse set of travellers from India moving across Europe and that is fascinating. The learning that we pick up from India is invaluable to us.

The Swiss travel pass is still the No. 1 [product] on our list. There is also the London-Paris Eurostar journey that is very popular. Other aspects that Indians like are the ICE and high-speed trains plus the night trains as well. The Top 3 destinations have remained the same, but a beautiful city like Budapest could work very well as a destination for, say, those visiting Europe for the second time.. [they] are a lot more adventurous then.

There are a few other things. Group travel was always big and that is only getting bigger. That is a positive from our point of view since they are constantly looking for new things. Like I said earlier, travelling once gives them more confidence on how to deal with the system and suddenly the desire for newer destinations takes off. It is our job to keep pace with the new trends.



Indian Institute of Management Raipur

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